

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage in Sikhism: the significance and purpose of marriage in Sikh life; Sikh teachings about marriage, including the Lavan by Guru Ram Das; divergent non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and the Sikh responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Sikh teaching about the importance of sexual relationships: divergent Sikh teaching about sexual relationships; Sikh teaching on sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships, including Guru Granth Sahib 4 and discussion of the January 2005 edict of the Jathedar of the Akal Takht in Amritsar; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Sikh responses to them.
2.3	Sikh teaching about the purpose and importance of the family: Sikh teaching about the purpose of families – procreation, security and education of children, including Guru Granth Sahib 71 and 599; divergent Sikh responses to the different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the Sikh community: how and why the local community tries to support families, including through family worship, rites of passage, classes for parents, groups for children and counselling; the importance of this support in the sangat for Sikhs today, including Rahit Maryada Chapter 10.
2.5	Sikh teaching on contraception: divergent Sikh teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to the concept of kaam and The Sikh Missionary Society Introduction to Sikhism, Section VII: Sikhism & Modern Problems Q124; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them.
2.6	Sikh teachings about divorce: divergent Sikh teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage, including reference to Rahit Maryada Chapter 11 and arguments used to support or reject divorce; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them.
2.7	Sikh teaching about the equality of men and women in the family: divergent Sikh beliefs, teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family including Guru Granth Sahib 788.
2.8	Divergent Sikh teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Sikh teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination, including Guru Granth Sahib 473; examples of Sikh opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	Features of the gurdwara: the nature, history and purpose of the design of the Gurdwara as the 'Door/Gate of the Guru', including Rahit Maryada Chapters 4–6; how and why objects of devotion are used within the gurdwara: Guru Granth Sahib, takht, chanani, chaur, the langar hall, four doors, and the Nishan Sahib; divergent understandings of the importance of these features in Sikh life today.
3.2	The gurdwara: the role and importance of the gurdwara within the Sikh community including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 1391; activities that take place within the gurdwara and why; the nature and importance of visiting Sikh historical gurdwaras: the Harmandir Sahib in Amritsar (the Golden Temple); divergent understandings of the importance of making such visits, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 4.
3.3	Langar: the history of langar including Guru Granth Sahib 967; the nature and purposes of langar; the significance of langar for Sikhs today, especially as an expression of sewa.
3.4	Nam Japna – meditating on the name of God: the nature and significance of Nam Japna; diverse ways in which the Nam Japna is used in the gurdwara and in Sikh daily life, including Guru Granth Sahib 1142.
3.5*	Prayer, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 305: the nature, role and purpose of prayer in the home; the different types of prayer; when prayer might take place and why; the importance of having different prayers.
3.6	Akhand path (continuous 48-hour reading of the Guru Granth Sahib): the nature, history, role and purpose of the akhand path including reference Rahit Maryada Chapter 7; how and why Sikhs might take part in the akhand path: why the akhand path is important for the Sikh community and for individual Sikhs.
3.7	Gurpurbs and commemorations: divergent understandings of the nature, history and purpose of gurpurbs and commemorations; why they are important for Sikhs today. The origins and meaning of gurpurbs, including Guru Nanak's birthday, Vaisakhi, including reference to the account of the events found in Gurbilas Patshahi 10. Divali: the origins and meaning of commemorations, including the martyrdom of Guru Arjan and Guru Tagh Bahadur Ji.
3.8	Birth and naming rituals and ceremonies: the celebration and significance of Naam Karan and Hukamnama; the significance of Amrit Sanskar (the initiation ceremony) for Sikh families, including reference to the Rahit Maryada Chapters 11 and 13; divergent understandings of these ceremonies between khalsa and non-khalsa Sikhs; the significance of the names Singh and Kaur in the naming and Amrit ceremonies, and for Sikh identity today.